

after commissions. This was my first triumph in Chicago commodities, and I was proud of it. Meanwhile, I was still short the 5,000 bushels of corn. Also, I still owned the option on the 30,000 pounds of live hogs, plus the mysterious deutsche-mark straddle.

Between all the debits and credits in my account, including a credit of \$437.50 for selling the corn, my actual cash outlay was \$1,417.50. That left me another \$600 worth of buying power.

Even with the yen problem cleared up, something was bothering me. I reviewed what had happened so far and realized what was wrong. From the traders I'd met, I'd seen no evidence of the great fortunes made in commodities. Where were the millionaires, the high-rollers with expensive cocaine habits, the owners of Caribbean islands that we associate with this fantastic business? Where was the champagne and the caviar? Where were the Lear jets bound for Paris? In all the various pits and the offices above them, I hadn't noticed a single fat bankroll, nor had I heard anybody mention easy money. The stories I'd heard so far were about humility, struggle, and disillusionment.

Perhaps these traders were just being cagey. The day after I took my positions, I returned to the pits, hoping to find at least one trader would tell me what he'd done with his millions, or else introduce me to others who'd made it big. I stood at the security check and had my new acquaintances paged off the floor.

They couldn't locate Howard Schless, the yen man, but I'd sold my yen, anyway. Ron Englund, the deutsche-mark man, was happy to see me again. He mentioned he was on the exchange education committee, and that he'd just come from a training session for prospective traders. There was a new session every week, starting on Monday. After an hour and a half of mock trading on Wednesday, and a short written exam on Thursday, the recruits were installed in the pits on Friday, gambling with real money, in business for themselves.

I asked Mr. Englund for names of traders who had gotten rich. He said there were some, but he couldn't think of any I could interview right then.

Over at the hog-option pit, empty as usual, I hailed Sonny Hersh in his checkered coat. He still looked downcast, and I'd barely said hello before he dropped the bombshell he'd been unable to